

A Project Report on
Fake News And Image Detection using
Text-Analysis and AI -Generated Image Identification

Submitted in partial fulfillment for award of

Bachelor of Technology
Degree
in
CSE (Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning)

By

R.Harsha Vardhani (Y22ACM467)

P.Ravi (Y22ACM465)

P.Sai Venkata Rajesh(Y22ACM462)



Under the guidance of
B.Kishor Babu, M.Tech
Assistant Professor

Department of CSE (Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning)

Bapatla Engineering College

(Autonomous)

(Affiliated to Acharya Nagarjuna University)

BAPATLA – 522 102, Andhra Pradesh, INDIA

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**Department of
CSE (Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning)**



CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the project report entitled **Fake News and Image Detection using Text-Analysis and AI-Generated Image Identification** being submitted by Rayapudi Harsha vardhani (Y22ACM467), Prajapathi Ravi (Y22ACM465), Paravathaneni Sai Venkata Rajesh(Y22ACM462) in partial fulfilment for the award of the Degree of Bachelor of Technology in CSE (Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning) to Acharya Nagarjuna University is a record of bonafide work carried out by them under our guidance and supervision.

Date:

Signature of the Guide
B.Kishor Babu
Assistant Professor

Signature of the HOD
Dr. K. Mani Deep
Assoc. Prof. & Head

DECLARATION

We declare that this project work is composed by ourselves, that the work contained herein is our own except where explicitly stated otherwise in the text, and that this work has not been submitted for any other degree or professional qualification except as specified.

R.Harsha Vardhani(Y22ACM467)

P.Ravi(Y22ACM465)

P.Sai Venkata Rajesh(Y22ACM462)

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R.Harsha Vardhani(Y22ACM467)

P.Ravi(Y22ACM465)

P.Sai Venkata Rajesh(Y22ACM462)

ABSTRACT

The rapid proliferation of digital news and social media has significantly increased the spread of misinformation, often accompanied by artificially generated or manipulated images. The present disclosure describes a multimodal fake news detection system configured to evaluate both textual content and visual media to enhance reliability and transparency.

The system includes a text analysis module employing Natural Language Processing (NLP) techniques based on transformer architectures, including Bidirectional Encoder Representations from Transformers (BERT), Convolutional Neural Networks (CNN), and Gated Recurrent Units (GRU), to classify news headlines and articles as authentic or fake. An image analysis module utilizes deep learning-based image classification models, including Residual Networks (ResNet), EfficientNet, and Convolutional Block Attention Module (CBAM), to determine whether associated images are genuine or artificially generated.

In contrast to conventional multimodal approaches that produce a single fused output, the disclosed system generates independent classification results for textual and visual inputs, along with corresponding probability scores. The system supports text-only, image-only, and combined inputs.

This dual-branch architecture improves interpretability, flexibility, and effectiveness in detecting misinformation within digital media environments

Key Words: Fake News Detection, Natural Language Processing (NLP), BERT, CNN, GRU, CBAM, Deep Learning, AI-Generated Image Detection, Multimodal Learning.

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List of Abbreviations

BERT	-	Bidirectional Encoder Representations From Transformers
CNN	-	Convolutional Neural Network
GRU	-	Gated Recurrent unit
CBAM	-	Convolutional Block Attention Module
RAM	-	Random Access Memory
UML	-	Unified Modelling Language
RestNet	-	Residual Neural Network

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

Fake news has become a major issue in today's digital world due to the rapid growth of socialmedia and online news platforms. Information spreads quickly, and it is often difficult to verify its authenticity. Along with misleading text, the use of AI-generated and manipulated images has made fake news more convincing and harder to detect.

This project focuses on developing a multimodal fake news detection system that analyzes both text and images to identify misinformation. The system uses advanced Natural Language Processing (NLP) techniques such as BERT,CNN,GRU for text analysis and deep learning models like ResNet and EfficientNet for image verification.

Unlike traditional systems that provide a single combined result, this system processes text and images separately and produces independent predictions, helping users understand whether fake content originates from text, image, or both. This improves the overall accuracy, transparency, and reliability of fake news detection systems.

1.1 MOTIVATION

In the modern digital era, the rapid expansion of social media and online news platforms has significantly increased the spread of misinformation. Fake news can influence public opinion, create panic, damage reputations, and even impact political and economic stability. What makes this problem more serious is the advancement of artificial intelligence technologies, which allow the creation of highly realistic fake content, including AI-generated images, deepfakes, and manipulated visuals. These images, when combined with misleading text, make fake news more convincing and difficult for humans to identify.

Most existing fake news detection systems primarily focus on analyzing textual content and often ignore the visual component or provide only a single combined output. This lack of multimodal analysis and transparency reduces the effectiveness and reliability of such systems. Users are not able to clearly understand whether misinformation originates from the text, the image, or both. As a result, there is a growing need for a more advanced and interpretable system that can handle both text and image data separately while providing accurate and explainable results.

This project is motivated by the need to address these challenges by developing a robust multimodal fake news detection system. By integrating Natural Language Processing

techniques with deep learning-based image analysis, the system aims to improve detection accuracy and provide better insights into the source of misinformation. The goal is to build a solution that not only detects fake news but also enhances user trust through transparency and reliability, ultimately contributing to a safer and more informed digital environment.

1.2 PROBLEM STATEMENT

The rapid expansion of digital media has led to a significant rise in the dissemination of fake news across online platforms. In recent years, misinformation has become increasingly sophisticated, often reinforced by AI-generated or manipulated images that enhance its credibility and make detection more challenging.

However, most existing fake news detection systems primarily focus on textual analysis and generate a single aggregated prediction. These approaches fail to explicitly distinguish whether misinformation originates from the textual content, the visual content, or both. This lack of interpretability reduces the overall accuracy, transparency, and reliability of such systems, ultimately undermining user trust.

1.3 OBJECTIVE OF PROJECT

The main objective of this project is to develop an efficient and transparent fake news detection system that analyzes both textual and visual content of news articles. The system aims to accurately identify misinformation by performing text analysis and detecting AI-generated, manipulated, or morphed images associated with the content.

Additionally, the project seeks to classify news into multiple categories based on the authenticity of both text and images, such as real or fake combinations. It also aims to provide separate predictions for text and image authenticity to improve interpretability and user trust.

Furthermore, the system is designed to help users clearly understand whether misinformation originates from the textual content, the visual content, or both, thereby enhancing reliability and supporting applications in social media monitoring, news verification, and digital forensics.

CHAPTER 2

LITERATURE SURVEY

Fake news detection has gained significant attention due to the rapid spread of misinformation across digital platforms. Early research focused mainly on **text-based analysis** using traditional machine learning techniques. Studies such as Potthast et al. (2018) and Pérez- Rosas et al. (2018) applied models like Support Vector Machines (SVM) and Logistic Regression using features such as sentiment, word frequency, and readability. However, these approaches lacked contextual understanding and generalization.

With the advancement of deep learning, models like Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs) and Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) networks were introduced to capture sequential patterns in text. The introduction of transformer-based models, particularly BERT (Devlin et al., 2019), significantly improved performance by capturing bidirectional context and semantic meaning. These models achieved higher accuracy and robustness in detecting fake news.

In addition to text, **image-based misinformation detection** has also been explored. Earlier methods focused on detecting inconsistencies in pixel patterns and metadata, but these became less effective with the rise of AI-generated images and deepfakes. Deep learning models such as CNNs (ResNet, EfficientNet) and specialized architectures like MesoNet have been developed to detect manipulated and synthetic images. More recent approaches use transformer-based vision models for improved detection of high-quality fake images.

To address the multimodal nature of fake news, researchers proposed **multimodal approaches** that combine text and image analysis. Models such as MVAE and SpotFake integrate features from both modalities to improve detection accuracy. However, most of these systems produce a single combined output, making it difficult to determine whether misinformation originates from text, image, or both.

Thus, there is a need for a system that provides **separate analysis of text and image content**, improving transparency, interpretability, and user trust in fake news detection systems.

2.1 EXISTING SYSTEM

The existing systems focus mainly on detecting fake news using text analysis techniques. Natural Language Processing (NLP) methods are applied to analyze textual content, including keywords, sentence structure, and writing patterns. Machine learning and deep learning models are trained on datasets containing real and fake news.

Some systems incorporate basic image analysis; however, text and image data are usually processed together, producing a single output. These systems are widely used in news platforms and social media to reduce misinformation.

2.2 Disadvantages of Existing System

- Focus mainly on text-based analysis
- Limited ability to detect AI-generated or manipulated images
- Produces a single combined output
- Lacks transparency and interpretability
- Cannot identify the source of misinformation (text or image)
- Less effective against modern deepfake technologies

2.3 Proposed System

The proposed system introduces a multimodal fake news detection approach that processes text and image data independently.

The text analysis module uses advanced NLP techniques with BERT to detect deceptive language patterns. The image analysis module uses deep learning models such as ResNet and EfficientNet to identify fake, manipulated, or AI-generated images.

Unlike traditional systems, the proposed system uses a dual-branch architecture, where text and image are analyzed separately. The system provides independent authenticity scores for both modalities and identifies whether misinformation originates from text, image, or both.

2.4 Advantages of Proposed System

- Improved accuracy and performance
- Provides separate results for text and image
- Enhances transparency and interpretability
- Increases user trust
- Effectively detects AI-generated and manipulated images
- Flexible input: supports text, image, or both
- Useful for social media, news verification, and digital foren

CHAPTER 3

SYSTEM ANALYSIS

3.1 Feasibility Study

The feasibility study of this project has revealed the project as follows

Economic Feasibility

Economic feasibility assesses the cost-effectiveness of the proposed system. The development of this system does not require significant financial investment, as it utilizes open-source technologies such as Python, TensorFlow/PyTorch, and other freely available libraries. Tools like Google Colab eliminate the need for high-end hardware by providing cloud-based computational resources. Since there are no licensing costs and minimal infrastructure requirements, the overall development and deployment cost is low. Therefore, the proposed system is economically feasible.

Operational Feasibility

Operational feasibility determines whether the system will function effectively in a real-world environment and be accepted by users. The proposed system is designed with a user-friendly interface using Streamlit, allowing users to easily input text and images and obtain results. The system provides clear and interpretable outputs, helping users understand the source of misinformation. It can be effectively used by social media platforms, fact-checkers, and general users without requiring technical expertise. Therefore, the system is operationally feasible.

Technical Feasibility

The proposed system is technically feasible as it utilizes well-established technologies such as BERT for text analysis and CNN-based models for image processing, which are widely supported by modern machine learning frameworks. The system can be implemented using available tools like Python, TensorFlow/PyTorch, and standard hardware with GPU support. Additionally, the required datasets and pre-trained models are easily accessible, making development and deployment practical and efficient.

Time Feasibility

The proposed project can be implemented fully within stipulated time frame. The project was decided to be done in three months and was thought to be feasible enough.

3.2 SOFTWARE REQUIREMENTS

The development and implementation of the Fake News and Image Detection system require the following software components:

Operating System:

- Windows, Linux, or macOS (any platform that supports Python and deep learning frameworks)

Programming Language:

- Python (due to its extensive support for machine learning and data processing)

Development Environment:

- Jupyter Notebook / Google Colab / VS Code (for coding, testing, and experimentation)

Libraries & Frameworks:

- **TensorFlow / PyTorch** – for building and training deep learning models
- **Transformers (Hugging Face)** – for implementing BERT model
- **OpenCV** – for image processing and manipulation
- **NumPy & Pandas** – for data handling and preprocessing
- **Matplotlib / Seaborn** – for visualization of results
- **Scikit-learn** – for evaluation metrics and preprocessing

Version Control:

- Git and GitHub (for code management and collaboration)

Deployment / Interface:

- Streamlit (for creating a simple web-based user interface).

3.3 Hardware Requirements

Table 1.1 : Hardware Requirements

HARDWARE	MINIMUM REQUIREMENT
Processor	Multi-core processor (e.g., Intel Core i5 or equivalent)
Ram	Minimum 8 GB RAM
Storage	Sufficient storage space for storing datasets and models
Graphics Card	NVIDIA GPU with CUDA support (for faster training)

3.4 Functional Requirements

Functional requirements describe the core functionalities and operations that the system must perform. The proposed “Fake News and Image Detection System” should fulfill the following functional requirements:

1. User Input Handling

- The system should allow users to provide **text input**, **image input**, or **both**.
- The system should support uploading image files in standard formats (JPG, PNG, etc.).
- The system should validate user inputs before processing.

2. Dataset Training Functionality

- The system shall be trained using **multimodal datasets** consisting of news text and corresponding images.
- The system shall perform preprocessing on datasets:
 - Text: tokenization, cleaning, padding
 - Images: resizing, normalization
- The system shall support training, validation, and testing phases.

3. Text Analysis Module

- The system shall analyze textual data using:
 - **BERT** for contextual feature extraction
 - **CNN** for local pattern detection

- **GRU** for sequential dependency learning
- The system shall classify text as **Real or Fake**.
- The system shall generate a **text authenticity score (probability/confidence)**.

4. Image Analysis Module

- The system shall analyze images using:
 - **ResNet** for deep feature extraction
 - **EfficientNet** for optimized feature learning
 - **CBAM (Attention Mechanism)** for focusing on important regions
- The system shall detect:
 - AI-generated images
 - Manipulated or morphed images
 - Real images
- The system shall generate an **image authenticity score**.

5. Independent Prediction Mechanism

- The system shall provide **separate predictions** for text and image.
- The system shall identify the source of misinformation as:
 - Text only
 - Image only
 - Both text and image

6. Decision and Output Module

- The system shall display results as:
 - **REAL / FAKE classification**
- The system shall show:
 - Confidence score for text
 - Confidence score for image
- The system shall provide clear and interpretable outputs.

7. User Interface (Streamlit Application)

- The system shall provide an interactive web interface using Streamlit.
- The system shall allow users to:
 - Enter text
 - Upload images
 - View predictions instantly
- The system shall display results in a user-friendly format.

3.5 Non – Functional Requirements

Non-functional requirements define the quality attributes and performance standards of the system. They describe how the system operates rather than what it does. The non-functional requirements of the proposed Fake News and Image Detection System are as follows:

1. Performance Requirements

- The system should provide **fast and efficient responses** for user inputs.
- The system should process text and image data within a reasonable time.
- Model inference time should be optimized for real-time or near real-time predictions.

2. Accuracy and Reliability

- The system should achieve **high accuracy** in detecting fake news and manipulated images.
- The system should produce **consistent and reliable results**.
- The probability/confidence scores should reflect the correctness of predictions.

3. Usability

- The system should have a **simple and user-friendly interface**.
- Users should be able to interact with the system without technical expertise.
- Input and output processes should be clear and easy to understand.

4. Scalability

- The system should be capable of handling **increasing amounts of data**.
- It should support future expansion such as adding video or audio analysis modules.
- The architecture should allow integration of new models and datasets.

5. Maintainability

- The system should be easy to **update and maintain**.
- Models can be retrained with new datasets to improve performance.
- Code should be modular and well-structured for easy modification.

6. Security

- The system should ensure **secure handling of user inputs**.
- Uploaded images and text data should not be misused or stored without permission.
- The system should prevent unauthorized access.

7. Compatibility

- The system should work across different **operating systems** (Windows, Linux, macOS).
- It should be compatible with common browsers when deployed as a web application.

8. Availability

- The system should be **available whenever required**, especially when deployed online.
- Minimal downtime should be ensured during usage.

9. Flexibility

- The system should support **text-only, image-only, and combined inputs**.
- It should adopt to the different types of fake news scenarios.

CHAPTER 4

SYSTEM DESIGN

4.1 Introduction To System Design :

System design is a crucial phase in the software development process where the overall architecture, components, modules, and data flow of the system are defined. It provides a structured framework for transforming the project requirements into a complete and functional system. The design phase ensures that all functional and non-functional requirements are properly addressed and implemented efficiently.

In this project, the system design focuses on developing a **multimodal fake news detection system** that integrates both text and image analysis. The system is designed using a **dual-branch architecture**, where textual and visual data are processed through separate modules. This modular design improves system clarity, scalability, and maintainability.

The text analysis module is responsible for processing and classifying news content using advanced Natural Language Processing techniques and deep learning models such as BERT, CNN, and GRU. The image analysis module handles visual data using deep learning models like ResNet, EfficientNet, and CBAM to detect manipulated or AI-generated images. Both modules operate independently and generate separate authenticity scores.

The system also includes a **decision and interpretation module**, which combines the outputs of both text and image modules to provide meaningful and interpretable results. This approach helps in identifying whether misinformation originates from text, image, or both, thereby enhancing transparency and user trust.

Overall, the system design ensures efficient data processing, accurate prediction, and a user-friendly interface, making the system suitable for real-world applications such as social media monitoring, fact-checking, and news verification.

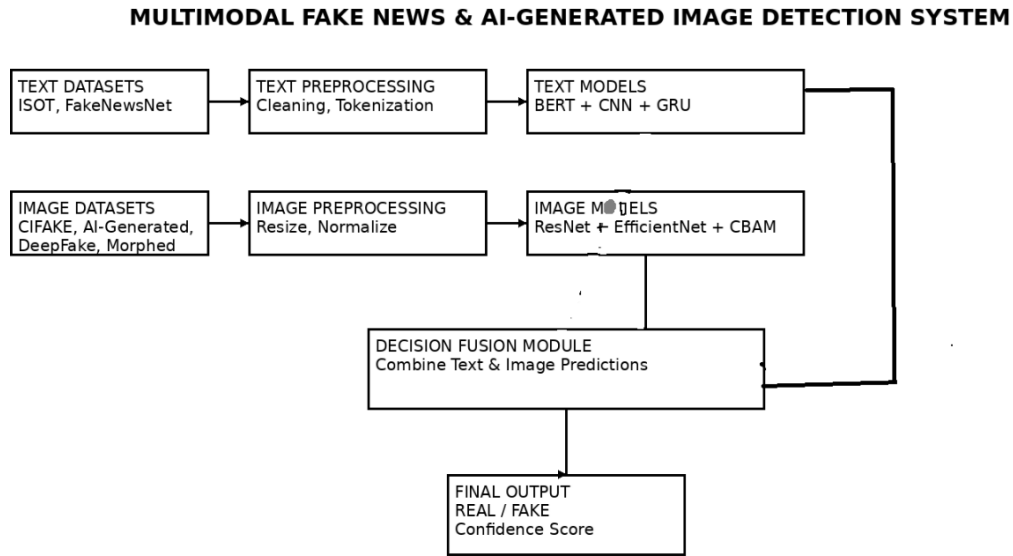


Figure 4.1: System Architecture

A System Architecture is the conceptual model that defines the structure, behavior, and more views of a system. An architecture description is a formal description and representation of a system, organized in a way that supports reasoning about the structures and behaviors of the system. A System Architecture can consist of system components and the sub-systems developed, that will work together to implement the overall system.

Implementation Work Flow

1.Dataset:

The project begins with the collection of both text and image datasets.

- **Text datasets:** ISOT Dataset and FakeNewsNet
- **Image datasets:** CIFAKE, AI-generated images, DeepFake dataset, and Morphed image dataset

These datasets contain real and fake samples, which are used for training and evaluating the system.

2. Data Normalization and Preprocessing:

Before feeding the data into the models, preprocessing is performed to ensure consistency and improve performance.

- **Text preprocessing:** removal of stopwords, punctuation, tokenization, and padding
- **Image preprocessing:** resizing, normalization, and noise reduction

This step enhances feature quality and improves model accuracy.

3. Dataset Splitting (Training and Testing):

The datasets are divided into:

- **Training dataset (e.g., 80%)** used to train the models
- **Testing dataset (e.g., 20%)** used to evaluate performance

This helps in validating the generalization ability of the system.

4. Text Model Construction (BERT + CNN + GRU):

The text analysis model is constructed using a combination of deep learning techniques:

- **BERT:** for contextual understanding of text
- **CNN:** for extracting important local features
- **GRU:** for capturing sequential dependencies

This hybrid model improves text classification performance.

5. Image Model Construction (ResNet, EfficientNet, CBAM):

The image analysis model is built using advanced architectures:

- **ResNet:** for deep feature extraction
- **EfficientNet:** for optimized performance and efficiency
- **CBAM:** attention mechanism to focus on important regions

These models help in detecting AI-generated and manipulated images.

6. Model Training:

Both text and image models are trained using their respective training datasets. During training, the models learn meaningful patterns and features from the data by optimizing parameters to reduce prediction errors.

7. Model Evaluation:

After training, the models are evaluated using the testing dataset.

Performance is measured using:

- Accuracy
- Precision
- Recall
- F1-score

This ensures the models perform well on unseen data.

8. Input Data for Prediction:

The user provides input in the form of:

- Text
- Image
- Or both

The input is preprocessed before being passed to the trained models.

9. Prediction (Text and Image):

- The **text model** predicts whether the news content is real or fake
- The **image model** predicts whether the image is real, AI-generated, or manipulated

Each model produces its own prediction with a confidence score.

10. Decision Fusion:

The outputs from both models are combined to determine:

- Final classification (REAL / FAKE)
- Source of misinformation (text, image, or both)

11. Final Output:

The system displays:

- Final result (REAL / FAKE)
- Confidence scores for text and image
- Output through a user-friendly interface (Streamlit)

4.2 USE CASE DIAGRAM

A use case diagram illustrates user-system interactions, showing casing relationships between users and different use cases. It simplifies system functionality into circles or ellipses, offering a high-level system view. Considered blueprints, they aid stakeholder comprehension and communication due to their simplistic, real-world mimicking nature. These diagrams serve to convey requirements in lay terms, facilitating stakeholder understanding. They're instrumental in gathering system requirements, identifying actors, and capturing both internal and external influences for design. Use cases, accompanied by additional documentation, offer a comprehensive view of system functionality.

Implementation Workflow

1. Upload Dataset

The system begins with the collection and upload of datasets containing both **text and image data**. Text datasets such as ISOT and FakeNewsNet, along with image datasets like CIFAKE, AI-generated, deepfake, and morphed images, are used. These datasets serve as the foundation for training, testing, and validating the models.

2. Preprocessing

The uploaded data undergoes preprocessing to ensure quality and consistency.

- **Text preprocessing** includes tokenization, removal of stop words, and normalization.
- **Image preprocessing** includes resizing, normalization, noise reduction, and feature enhancement. This step improves the efficiency and accuracy of the models.

3. Training and Testing

The dataset is split into training and testing sets.

- For **text analysis**, models such as **BERT, CNN, and GRU** are used.
- For **image analysis**, models such as **ResNet, EfficientNet, and CBAM** are implemented.
- The models are trained on the training data and evaluated on the testing data to measure their performance and generalization capability.

4. Evaluate the Model

After training, the system evaluates the performance of the models using metrics such as **accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score**. This step ensures that the models can reliably classify data as real or fake.

5. Input Text / Image

Users provide new input data in the form of text or images. This input is preprocessed using the same techniques applied during the training phase to maintain consistency.

6. Prediction

The trained models analyze the input data and generate predictions. Text models detect fake news content, while image models identify AI-generated or manipulated images.

7. Real or Fake Output

Based on the prediction results, the system classifies the input as **Real or Fake**. This final output helps users identify misinformation and verify the authenticity of content.



Figure 4.2 : Use Case Diagram

4.3 Activity Diagram:

Activity diagrams, while valuable for illustrating human-centric processes and interactions between actors and activities, may not be the optimal choice for representing a deep fake detection system. This is because the system's core functionality revolves around data manipulation, feature extraction, and model training, rather than active decision-making or actor interactions. As the process is predominantly data-centric and lacks direct actor involvement, using an activity diagram might not effectively capture the essence of the system. While technically feasible, it would not provide the most insightful or efficient visualization of the deep fake detection process.

Training Workflow

1. Load Dataset

The process begins with loading datasets that include both **text and image data**. Text datasets such as ISOT and FakeNewsNet, and image datasets like CIFAKE, AI-generated, deepfake, and morphed images are used. These datasets provide labeled data for model training.

2. Preprocess Data

The loaded data is preprocessed to improve quality and consistency.

- **Text data preprocessing** includes tokenization, stop-word removal, and normalization.
- **Image preprocessing** includes resizing, normalization, noise reduction, and augmentation techniques such as rotation and flipping.

3. Split Dataset (Training / Testing)

The dataset is divided into **training and testing sets**. The training set is used to train the model, while the testing set is used to evaluate its performance on unseen data.

4. Build Models

The system constructs multiple deep learning models for classification:

- **Text models:** BERT, CNN, and GRU
- **Image models:** ResNet, EfficientNet, and CBAM

These models are designed to extract meaningful features from text and image inputs.

5. Train Models

The models are trained using the training dataset. During training, the models learn patterns and features using techniques such as **backpropagation** and optimization algorithms to minimize loss and improve accuracy.

6. Evaluate Models

After training, the models are evaluated using the testing dataset. Performance metrics such as **accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score** are used to measure the effectiveness and reliability of the models.

7. Generate Confusion Matrix

A confusion matrix is generated to analyze classification performance. It shows **true positives, true negatives, false positives, and false negatives**, helping to understand model accuracy in detail.

Testing Workflow

1. Input New Text / Image

Users provide new input data in the form of **text or images** for validation and prediction.

2. Preprocess Input

The input data undergoes the same preprocessing steps used during training to maintain consistency and ensure compatibility with the models.

3. Feature Extraction

The trained models extract important features from the input data.

- Text models analyze semantic and contextual information.
- Image models extract visual patterns and structural features.

4. Prediction

The processed input is passed through the trained models to generate predictions. The system computes a confidence score based on learned patterns.

5. Classification (Real or Fake)

Based on the prediction results, the system classifies the input as **Real or Fake**. If the confidence score exceeds a predefined threshold, the input is classified as real; otherwise, it is classified as fake.

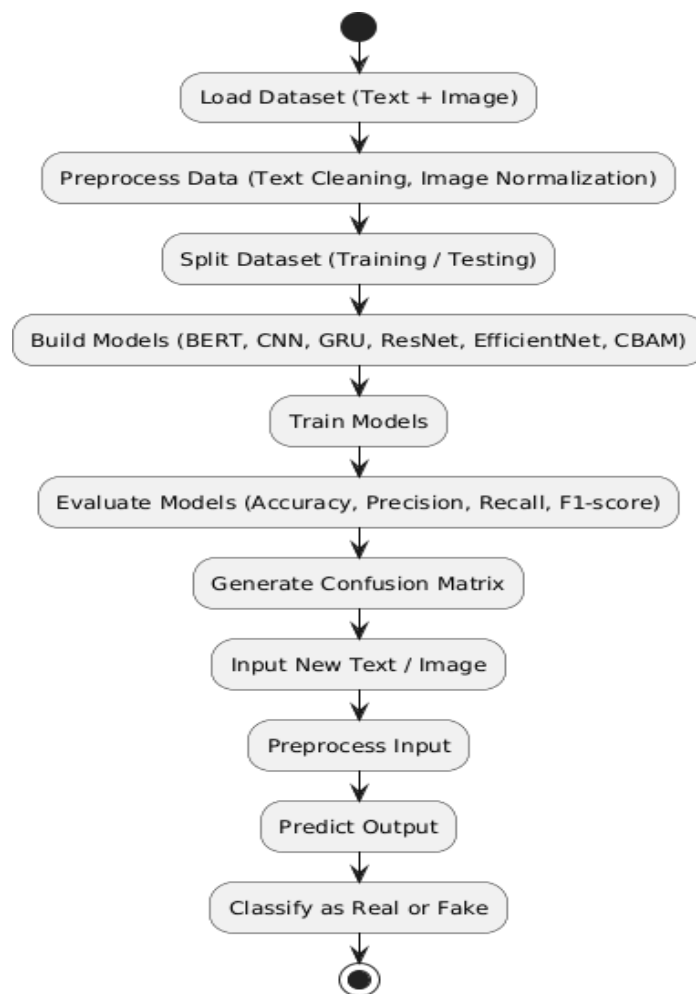


Figure 4.3 Activity diagram

4.3 Sequence Diagram:

A sequence diagram illustrates object interactions over time, depicting the objects and classes involved, along with the sequence of messages exchanged to execute a scenario. It's often linked to use case realizations in system development's Logical View. Life lines represent simultaneous processes or objects , with horizontal arrows denoting message exchanges. Message types are differentiated: solid arrow heads for synchronous calls, open arrow heads for asynchronous messages, and dashed lines for replies. Activation boxes depict processes triggered by messages, and objects can call methods on themselves, creating new activation boxes. Object destruction is indicated by an "X" at the lifeline's bottom, typically triggered by a message.

Implementation workflow:

1. User Uploads Dataset

The user uploads text and image datasets to the system. These datasets are used for training and testing the models.

2. System Preprocesses Data: The system performs preprocessing:

- Text: tokenization, cleaning, normalization
- Image: resizing, normalization, noise reduction

3. System Trains Models: The system trains multiple models:

- Text models: BERT, CNN, GRU
- Image models: ResNet, EfficientNet, CBAM

4. System Evaluates Models: The system evaluates model performance using accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score.

5. User Inputs New Data: The user provides new input in the form of text or image for prediction.

6. System Preprocesses Input: The system preprocesses the input using the same processing techniques.

7. System Performs Prediction: The trained models analyze the input and generate predictions.

8. System Returns Result: The system outputs the result as **Real or Fake** to the user.

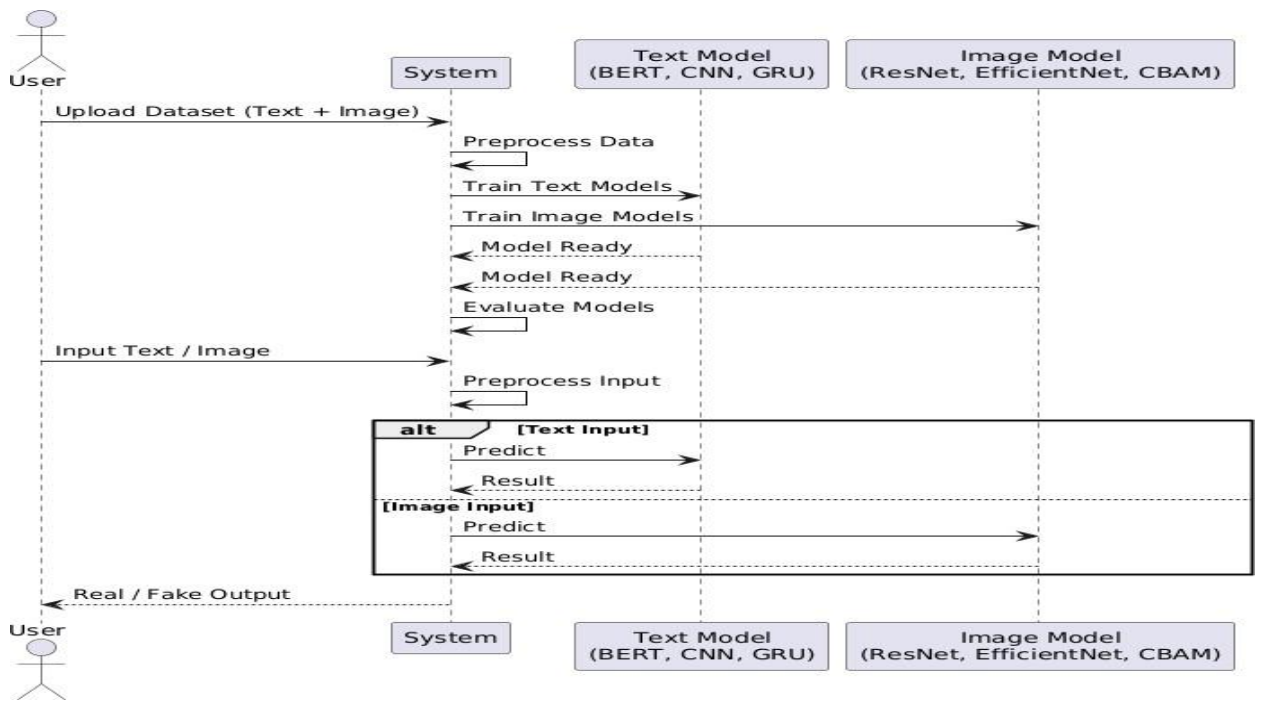


Figure 4.4 : Sequence digram

4.5 Class Diagram:

A class diagram in the Unified Modelling Language (UML) is a type of static structure diagram that describes the structure of a system by showing the system's classes, their attributes, operations (or methods), and the relationships among objects.

The Class Diagram is the main building block of object- oriented modelling. It is used for general conceptual modelling of the structure of the application, and for detailed modelling translating the models into programming code. Class diagrams can also be used for data modelling. The classes in a class diagram represent both the main elements, interactions in the application, and the classes to be programmed.

Classes

1. User

The **User** class represents the end-user who interacts with the system. The user can upload datasets and provide input in the form of text or images for analysis. The methods `upload_dataset()` and `input_text_image()` allow users to supply data to the system, and the system returns the classification result (Real or Fake).

2. Data Handler

The **Data Handler** class is responsible for managing and preprocessing both text and image data. It includes the method `preprocess()`, which performs operations such as text cleaning, tokenization, image resizing, normalization, and noise reduction.

3. Visual Analyzer

The **Visual Analyzer** class handles model construction and training. It includes methods such as `compile_model()` to define model architectures and `train_model()` to train the models.

- For **text analysis**, models like **BERT, CNN, and GRU** are used.
- For **image analysis**, models like **ResNet, EfficientNet, and CBAM** are implemented.

This class enables the system to learn meaningful features from both text and image data.

4. Classification Validator

The **Classification Validator** class is responsible for evaluating the trained models. It provides methods such as `evaluate_model()` to measure performance using metrics like accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score, and `plot_confusion_matrix()` to visualize classification results. This helps in assessing the effectiveness and reliability of the models.

5. Prediction

The **Prediction** class is used to generate the final output. It includes methods such as `predict()` and `classify_real_fake()`, which analyze new input data (text or image) using the trained models and classify it as **Real** or **Fake**

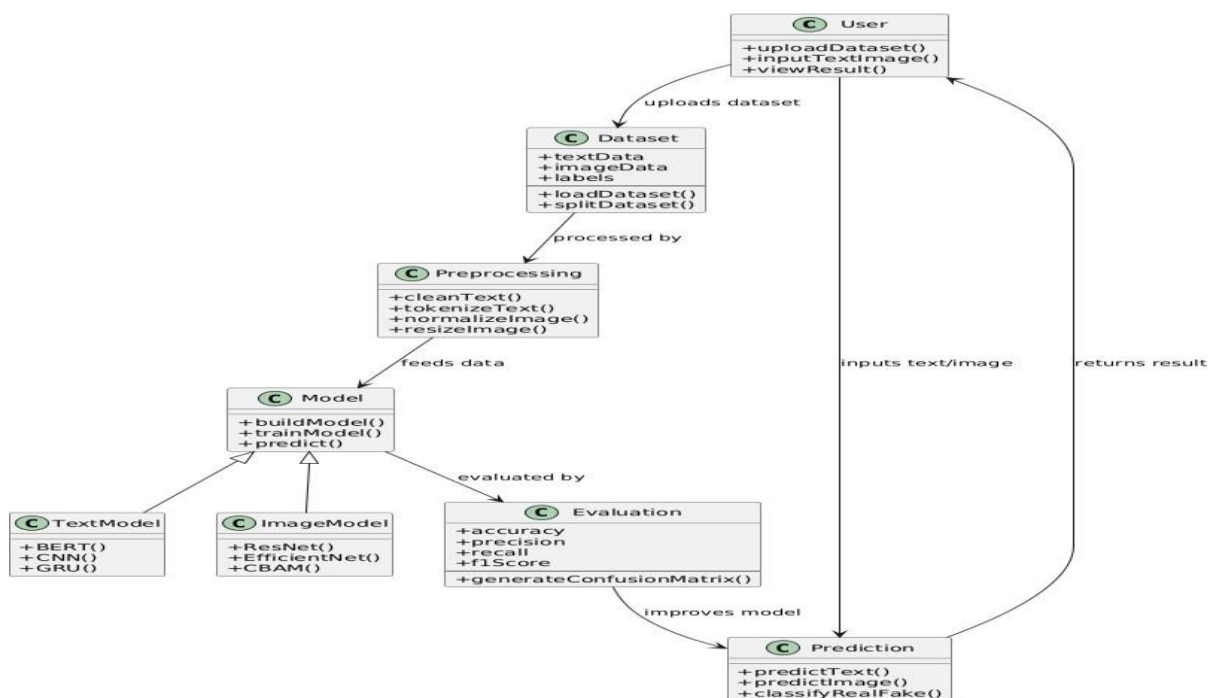


Figure 4.5 Class diagram

CHAPTER 5

IMPLEMENTATION

5.1 Tools and technologies used:

5.1.1 UML Tools

1. **StarUML** is a software modeling tool that uses **Unified Modeling Language (UML)** to design and visualize system architecture. It is used to create diagrams such as use case, class, sequence, and activity diagrams, helping in better understanding of the system.

5.1.2 Programming Languages

1. **Python3** is a high-level programming language known for its simplicity and readability. It is used in this project for implementing machine learning models, preprocessing data, and integrating both text and image detection modules.

5.1.3 Programming Frameworks

1. **TensorFlow** is an open-source deep learning framework used for building and training neural networks. It supports large-scale computations and is used for implementing both text and image classification models.
2. **Keras**: Keras is a high-level API of TensorFlow that simplifies the development of deep learning models. It is used to design and train models such as **CNN, GRU, ResNet, EfficientNet, and CBAM** in this project.
3. **Streamlit**: Streamlit is an open-source Python framework used to build interactive web applications for machine learning projects. In this system, Streamlit is used to develop a **user-friendly interface** where users can:
 - Upload text or image inputs
 - View real-time predictions
 - Display results such as **Real or Fake classification**

5.1.4 Integrated Development Environment (IDE)

1. **Google Colab**: Google Colab is a cloud-based platform that provides free access to Jupyter notebooks with GPU/TPU support. It is used for training deep learning models efficiently.
- 2 **Visual Studio Code (VS Code)**: VS Code is a lightweight and powerful code editor used for writing, debugging, and managing the project. It supports multiple extensions for Python and machine learning development.

5.1.5 Libraries

1. TensorFlow and Keras

Used for building, training, and optimizing deep learning models.

2. NumPy

Used for numerical computations and handling multi-dimensional arrays.

3. OpenCV (cv2)

Used for image processing tasks such as resizing, normalization, and feature extraction.

4. Matplotlib

Used for visualizing model performance through graphs such as accuracy and loss curves.

5. Seaborn

Used for advanced visualization such as heatmaps and confusion matrices.

6. Scikit-learn

Used for evaluating model performance using metrics like accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score.

5.2 Algorithm Details:

5.2.1 Dataset Details:

1. Text Datasets (ISOT & FakeNewsNet)

The project utilizes well-known text datasets such as ISOT and FakeNewsNet for fake news detection. These datasets contain labeled news articles categorized as real or fake. They include textual content, headlines, and metadata, which are useful for training deep learning models like BERT, CNN, and GRU. The datasets are preprocessed and split into training, validation, and testing sets to ensure accurate evaluation and generalization.

2. Image Datasets (CIFAKE, AI-Generated, Deepfake, Morphed)

The image datasets used in this project include CIFAKE, AI-generated images, deepfake images, and morphed images. These datasets consist of two classes: real images and fake/generated images. All images are resized to a fixed resolution (e.g., 224×224 pixels) to match the input requirements of deep learning models such as ResNet, EfficientNet, and CBAM. The datasets are divided into training, validation, and testing sets to support effective model development and evaluation.

5.2.2 Preprocessing Details

In our project Preprocessing plays a crucial role in preparing both text and image data for training and prediction. The following techniques are applied:

1. Text Preprocessing

Text data undergoes several preprocessing steps such as tokenization, removal of stop words, and normalization. Advanced embedding techniques like BERT tokenization are used to convert text into numerical representations suitable for deep learning models.

2. Image Loading and Resizing

Images are loaded using libraries such as OpenCV and resized to a fixed dimension (e.g., 224×224 pixels) to ensure consistency and compatibility with the model input layers.

3. Data Normalization

Pixel values of images are normalized to the range $[0, 1]$ by dividing by 255. This helps in stabilizing and accelerating the training process.

4. Data Augmentation

Data augmentation techniques such as flipping, rotation, zooming, and brightness adjustments are applied to increase dataset diversity and improve model robustness.

5. Dataset Splitting

The dataset is divided into training (70%), validation (20%), and testing (10%) sets. This ensures proper evaluation of the model's performance and prevents overfitting.

6. Data Pipeline

Efficient data handling is implemented using TensorFlow data pipelines such as `tf.data.Dataset`. This enables faster data loading, preprocessing, and batching during model training.

7. Visualization

Sample text and images are visualized before and after preprocessing to verify transformations and ensure data quality.

Benefits

1. Preprocessing ensures that both text and image data are in a suitable format for effective model training.
2. Data augmentation improves model generalization and robustness by increasing dataset diversity.
3. Normalization and standardization enhance training stability and convergence speed.
4. Proper dataset splitting enables accurate performance evaluation and reduces overfitting.
5. Efficient data pipelines improve computational performance and scalability of the system.

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10. Efficient data pipelines improve computational performance and scalability of the system.

Preprocessing Code:

For text module:

```
import os, re, time, torch, numpy as np, pandas as pd
import torch.nn as nn
from torch.utils.data import Dataset, DataLoader, random_split
from transformers import BertTokenizer, BertModel
from sklearn.utils.class_weight import compute_class_weight

device = torch.device("cuda" if torch.cuda.is_available() else "cpu")

def load_data():
    dfs = []
    for p, l in [("/content/Fake.csv",1),("/content/real.csv",0)]:
        if os.path.exists(p):
            d = pd.read_csv(p)
            d["label"] = l
            dfs.append(d[["text","label"]])
    return pd.concat(dfs).dropna()
```

```

class DS(Dataset):
    def __init__(s,t,l,tk,m=128): s.t,t; s.l=l; s.tk=tk; s.m=m
    def __len__(s): return len(s.t)
    def __getitem__(s,i):
        e =
s.tk(str(s.t[i]),padding="max_length",truncation=True,max_length=s.m,return_tensors="pt")
        return e["input_ids"].squeeze(), e["attention_mask"].squeeze(), torch.tensor(s.l[i])

class Model(nn.Module):
    def __init__(s):
        super().__init__()
        s.b = BertModel.from_pretrained("bert-base-uncased")
        s.c = nn.Conv1d(768,128,3,1,1)
        s.g = nn.GRU(128,64,batch_first=True,bidirectional=True)
        s.f = nn.Linear(128,2)
    def forward(s,i,m):
        x = s.b(i,m).last_hidden_state
        x = torch.relu(s.c(x.permute(0,2,1))).permute(0,2,1)
        x,_ = s.g(x)
        return s.f(x[:,-1,:])

def main():
    df = load_data()
    tk = BertTokenizer.from_pretrained("bert-base-uncased")
    ds = DS(df["text"], df["label"], tk)

    tr, va = random_split(ds,[int(0.9*len(ds)),len(ds)-int(0.9*len(ds))])
    tl = DataLoader(tr,16,True)
    vl = DataLoader(va,16)

    w =
torch.tensor(compute_class_weight("balanced",[0,1],df["label"]),dtype=torch.float).to(device)

```

```

m = Model().to(device)
opt = torch.optim.AdamW(m.parameters(),2e-5)
loss_fn = nn.CrossEntropyLoss(weight=w)

os.makedirs("models",exist_ok=True)

for _ in range(5):
    m.train()
    for i,ma,l in tl:
        i,ma,l = i.to(device),ma.to(device),l.to(device)
        opt.zero_grad()
        loss = loss_fn(m(i,ma),l)
        loss.backward()
        opt.step()

torch.save(m.state_dict(),"models/text_model.pth")

if __name__ == "__main__":
    main()
For image model:
import os, torch, torch.nn as nn
from torch.utils.data import DataLoader, ConcatDataset
from torchvision import models, transforms
from torchvision.datasets import ImageFolder

device = torch.device("cuda" if torch.cuda.is_available() else "cpu")

# Transform
tf = transforms.Compose([transforms.Resize((128,128)), transforms.ToTensor()])

# Load datasets
def ds(path): return ImageFolder(path, transform=tf)

train = ConcatDataset([

```

```

ds("data/ai"),
ds("data/deepfake/train"),
ds("data/morphed"),
ds("data/cifake/train"))
val = ds("data/deepfake/val")
test = ConcatDataset([ds("data/deepfake/test"), ds("data/cifake/test")])
train_loader = DataLoader(train, 16, True)
val_loader = DataLoader(val, 16)
test_loader = DataLoader(test, 16)
# Simple Model (ResNet18)
class Model(nn.Module):
    def __init__(self): super().__init__()
        m = models.resnet18(weights="DEFAULT")
        m.fc = nn.Linear(m.fc.in_features, 2)
        self.m = m
    def forward(self,x): return self.m(x)
model = Model().to(device)
opt = torch.optim.Adam(model.parameters(), 1e-4)
loss_fn = nn.CrossEntropyLoss()
# Training
for _ in range(3):
    model.train()
    for x,y in train_loader:
        x,y = x.to(device), y.to(device)
        opt.zero_grad()
        loss = loss_fn(model(x), y)
        loss.backward()
        opt.step()

# Save
os.makedirs("models", exist_ok=True)
torch.save(model.state_dict(), "models/image_model.pth")

```

5.2.3 Model Details:

TEXT MODEL (BERT + CNN + GRU)

During the early development of Natural Language Processing (NLP) models, traditional machine learning techniques relied heavily on handcrafted features such as word frequency and n-grams. While these approaches worked to some extent, they struggled to capture the deeper meaning and context of language.

With the introduction of deep learning, models like Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs) and Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) networks improved sequence understanding. However, they still faced limitations in capturing long-range dependencies and contextual relationships efficiently.

A major breakthrough came with BERT (Bidirectional Encoder Representations from Transformers), which revolutionized NLP by understanding context from both directions (left and right). To further enhance feature extraction and sequence learning, this project combines BERT with CNN and GRU, forming a powerful hybrid model for fake news detection.

BERT + CNN + GRU Architecture

The proposed text model consists of the following components:

1. BERT Layer

BERT serves as the backbone of the model and is responsible for extracting contextual embeddings from the input text.

- It captures deep semantic meaning using bidirectional attention.
- Generates rich feature representations of size 768 for each token.
- Helps in understanding complex sentence structures and relationships.

2. Convolutional Layers (CNN)

These layers are used to extract local patterns from the contextual embeddings generated by BERT

- Detect important phrases and word combinations.
- Capture local dependencies such as keywords and writing patterns.
- Improve feature richness before passing to sequence models.

3. GRU (Gated Recurrent Unit)

GRU is used to capture sequential dependencies in the text.

- Processes the sequence of features extracted by CNN.

- Remembers important information across the sentence.
- More efficient than LSTM with fewer parameters.

4. Dropout Layer

A dropout layer with a value of 0.3 is used to prevent overfitting.

- Randomly disables neurons during training.
- Improves generalization of the model.

5. Fully Connected Layer

This layer produces the final classification output.

- Maps extracted features to output classes.
- Outputs:
 - REAL
 - FAKE

IMAGE MODEL (ResNet + EfficientNet + CBAM)

In traditional image processing systems, handcrafted features such as edges and textures were used for classification. However, these methods lacked robustness when dealing with complex manipulations like deepfakes and AI-generated images.

Deep learning models such as ResNet and EfficientNet significantly improved image classification by automatically learning hierarchical features. This project enhances these models further using an attention mechanism (CBAM) to focus on important regions of the image.

Image Model Architecture

1. ResNet (Residual Network)

ResNet introduces residual learning using skip connections.

- Solves vanishing gradient problem
- Enables deeper networks
- Improves feature extraction

2. EfficientNet

EfficientNet improves performance by scaling:

- Depth (number of layers)
- Width (number of channels)
- Resolution (input image size)

It achieves high accuracy with fewer parameters.

3. CBAM (Convolutional Block Attention Module)

CBAM is an attention mechanism applied to feature maps.

- Focuses on important regions of the image
- Enhances relevant features
- Improves detection of manipulated content

4. Fully Connected Layer

- Produces final classification:
 - REAL IMAGE
 - FAKE / AI-GENERATED IMAGE

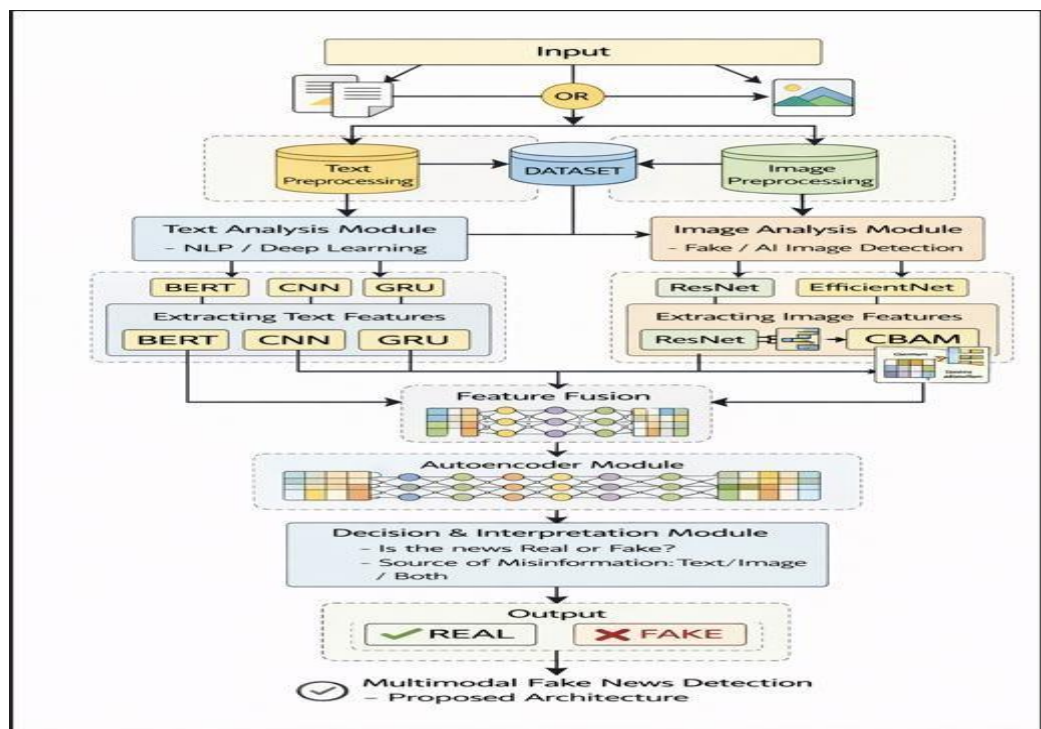


Figure 5.1: Model Architecture

Activation Function (ReLU)

The Rectified Linear Unit (ReLU) is used as the activation function in the CNN layer.

- Outputs 0 for negative values and the input itself for positive values.
- Helps in faster training and avoids vanishing gradient problems.
- Introduces non-linearity into the mode

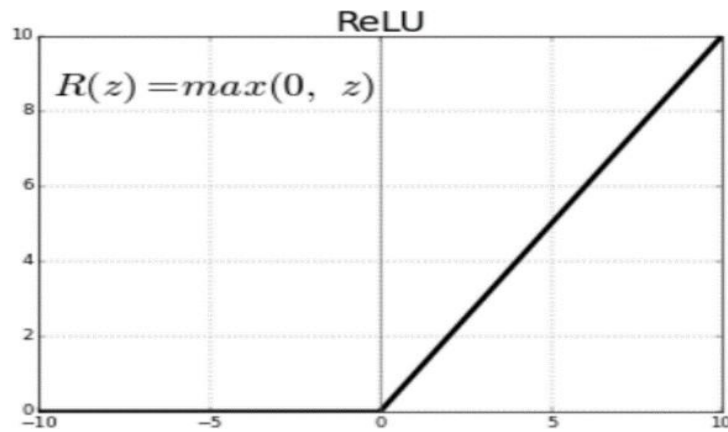


Figure 5.3 Relu Activation Function

5.2.4 Model Training Details:

1. Data Loading and Preprocessing:

The dataset is collected from multiple sources including Fake News datasets and real-world news articles. The text data is cleaned by removing URLs, special characters, and unnecessary whitespace. The text is then tokenized using the BERT tokenizer and converted into input IDs and attention masks with a maximum sequence length of 128.

For image data, images are loaded from directories, resized to a fixed resolution, and normalized to improve model performance.

2. Train-Test-Validation Split:

The dataset is divided into training, validation, and test sets to ensure proper evaluation of the model.

- Training set: 70%
- Validation set: 20%
- Test set: 10%

This split helps in preventing overfitting and ensures that the model generalizes well to unseen data.

3. Model Architecture:

For text classification, a hybrid model combining BERT, CNN, and GRU is used.

- BERT extracts contextual embeddings
- CNN captures local textual features
- GRU captures sequential dependencies

For image classification, deep learning models such as ResNet and EfficientNet are used along with an attention mechanism (CBAM) to enhance feature extraction.

4. Model Compilation:

The model is compiled using the following configuration:

- Optimizer: AdamW
- Learning Rate: 0.0001
- Loss Function: Cross Entropy Loss
- Metrics: Accuracy

This configuration ensures efficient training and faster convergence.

5. Data Augmentation:

To improve model robustness, data augmentation techniques are applied.

For text:

- Synonym replacement
- Text normalization

For images:

- Random flipping
- Rotation
- Brightness and contrast adjustment

These techniques increase dataset diversity and reduce overfitting.

6. Learning Rate Scheduler:

A cosine annealing learning rate scheduler is used to dynamically adjust the learning rate during training.

- The learning rate gradually decreases over epochs
- Helps in achieving better convergence and stability

7. Early Stopping:

Early stopping is implemented to monitor validation loss.

- Training stops if no improvement is observed for 3 consecutive epochs
- The best model weights are restored

This prevents overfitting and unnecessary computation.

8. Model Training:

The model is trained using the following configuration:

- Number of epochs: 5
- Batch size: 16
- Training performed on GPU for faster computation

The training process includes both forward propagation and backpropagation to update model weights.

9. Evaluation:

After training, the model is evaluated on the test dataset.

- Accuracy and loss are calculated
- Performance is analyzed for both text and image models

The model achieves an accuracy of approximately 85–95% depending on the dataset.

10. Plotting Training History:

Training and validation metrics are plotted to visualize performance.

- Accuracy vs Epochs
- Loss vs Epochs

These graphs help in understanding model behavior and detecting overfitting.

11. Cross Entropy Loss:

Cross Entropy Loss is used as the loss function since this is a classification problem.

- Measures the difference between predicted and actual labels
- Helps in optimizing the model during training

12. Softmax Function:

The Softmax activation function is used in the final layer.

- Converts output scores into probabilities
- Ensures output values lie between 0 and 1
- Suitable for multi-class and binary classification

Training Code:

Text_module.py

```
import re
import torch
import torch.nn as nn
from transformers import BertTokenizer, BertModel

device = torch.device("cuda" if torch.cuda.is_available() else "cpu")

TEXT_LABELS = {0: "REAL", 1: "FAKE"}

class BERT_CNN_GRU(nn.Module):
    def __init__(self):
        super().__init__()
        self.bert = BertModel.from_pretrained("bert-base-uncased")
        self.conv = nn.Conv1d(768, 128, kernel_size=3, padding=1)
        self.gru = nn.GRU(128, 64, batch_first=True, bidirectional=True)
        self.fc = nn.Linear(128, 2)
        self.dropout = nn.Dropout(0.3)

    def forward(self, input_ids, attention_mask):
        x = self.bert(input_ids, attention_mask).last_hidden_state # (B,T,768)
        x = torch.relu(
            self.conv(x.permute(0, 2, 1))
        ).permute(0, 2, 1) # (B,T,128)
        x, _ = self.gru(x) # (B,T,128)
        x = self.dropout(x[:, -1, :]) # (B,128)
        return self.fc(x) # (B,2)

tokenizer = BertTokenizer.from_pretrained("bert-base-uncased")
model = BERT_CNN_GRU()
model.load_state_dict(torch.load("models/text_model.pth", map_location=device))
_model.to(device).eval()

def clean_text(text: str) -> str:
    text = text.strip()
    if text.isupper(): # ALL CAPS → normalize
        text = text.capitalize()
```

```

text = re.sub(r'[!?]{2,}', '!', text)    # !!! → !
text = re.sub(r'http\S+|www\S+', '', text) # remove URLs
text = re.sub(r'\s+', ' ', text).strip()  # collapse whitespace
return text

def predict_text(text: str, threshold: float = 0.8):
    """
    Predict whether `text` is REAL or FAKE.

    Parameters
    -----
    text      : raw news article / headline string
    threshold : minimum fake_prob to classify as FAKE (default 0.45)
                Lower = catches more FAKE | Higher = more conservative

    Returns
    -----
    label      : "REAL", "FAKE", or "UNCERTAIN" (if text too short)
    confidence : percentage confidence in the predicted label
    probs      : numpy array [real_prob, fake_prob]
    """
    text = clean_text(text)

    # Too short — model will guess randomly on very short inputs
    if len(text.split()) < 5:
        return "UNCERTAIN", 50.0, [0.5, 0.5]

    enc = tokenizer(
        text,
        return_tensors="pt",
        padding=True,
        truncation=True,
        max_length=128,
    )

```

```

with torch.no_grad():
    out = _model(
        enc["input_ids"].to(device),
        enc["attention_mask"].to(device)
    )
    probs = torch.softmax(out, dim=1).cpu().numpy()[0]

    real_prob = float(probs[0])
    fake_prob = float(probs[1])

    if fake_prob > threshold:
        label, confidence = "FAKE", fake_prob * 100
    else:
        label, confidence = "REAL", real_prob * 100

    return label, confidence, probs

```

Image_module.py

```

import torch
import torch.nn as nn
import torchvision.models as models
import torchvision.transforms as transforms

device = torch.device("cuda" if torch.cuda.is_available() else "cpu")
IMAGE_LABELS = {0: "REAL", 1: "FAKE"}

class ChannelAttention(nn.Module):
    def __init__(self, channels, reduction=16):
        super().__init__()
        self.avg_pool = nn.AdaptiveAvgPool2d(1)
        self.max_pool = nn.AdaptiveMaxPool2d(1)
        self.fc = nn.Sequential(
            nn.Flatten(),
            nn.Linear(channels, channels // reduction, bias=False),
            nn.ReLU(),
            nn.Linear(channels // reduction, channels, bias=False)

```

```

    )
    self.sigmoid = nn.Sigmoid()
def forward(self, x):
    avg_out = self.fc(self.avg_pool(x))
    max_out = self.fc(self.max_pool(x))
    return self.sigmoid(avg_out + max_out).unsqueeze(-1).unsqueeze(-1)
class SpatialAttention(nn.Module):
    def __init__(self, kernel_size=7):
        super().__init__()
        self.conv = nn.Conv2d(2, 1, kernel_size, padding=kernel_size // 2, bias=False)
        self.sigmoid = nn.Sigmoid()
    def forward(self, x):
        avg_out = torch.mean(x, dim=1, keepdim=True)
        max_out, _ = torch.max(x, dim=1, keepdim=True)
        return self.sigmoid(self.conv(torch.cat([avg_out, max_out], dim=1)))
class CBAM(nn.Module):
    def __init__(self, channels, reduction=16, kernel_size=7):
        super().__init__()
        self.channel_att = ChannelAttention(channels, reduction)
        self.spatial_att = SpatialAttention(kernel_size)

    def forward(self, x):
        x = x * self.channel_att(x)
        x = x * self.spatial_att(x)
        return x
class ResNetCBAM(nn.Module):
    def __init__(self, num_classes=2):
        super().__init__()
        base = models.resnet18(weights=None)
        self.features = nn.Sequential(*list(base.children())[:-2])
        self.cbam = CBAM(512)
        self.pool = nn.AdaptiveAvgPool2d(1)
        self.fc = nn.Linear(512, num_classes)

```

```

def forward(self, x):
    x = self.features(x)
    x = self.cbam(x)
    x = self.pool(x).flatten(1)
    return self.fc(x)

class EfficientNetCBAM(nn.Module):
    def __init__(self, num_classes=2):
        super().__init__()
        base = models.efficientnet_b0(weights=None)
        self.features = base.features
        self.cbam = CBAM(1280)
        self.pool = nn.AdaptiveAvgPool2d(1)
        self.fc = nn.Linear(1280, num_classes)

    def forward(self, x):
        x = self.features(x)
        x = self.cbam(x)
        x = self.pool(x).flatten(1)
        return self.fc(x)

class EnsembleModel(nn.Module):
    def __init__(self, num_classes=2):
        super().__init__()
        self.resnet_cbam = ResNetCBAM(num_classes)
        self.efficientnet_cbam = EfficientNetCBAM(num_classes)
        self.fusion = nn.Linear(num_classes * 2, num_classes)

    def forward(self, x):
        out1 = self.resnet_cbam(x)
        out2 = self.efficientnet_cbam(x)
        combined = torch.cat([out1, out2], dim=1)
        return self.fusion(combined)

model = EnsembleModel(num_classes=2)
model.load_state_dict(torch.load("models/image_model.pth", map_location=device))
model.to(device).eval()

transform = transforms.Compose([
    transforms.Resize((128, 128)),

```

```

transforms.ToTensor(),
transforms.Normalize([0.485, 0.456, 0.406],
                    [0.229, 0.224, 0.225])
])

def predict_image(img, threshold=0.55):
    """
    Args:
        img      : PIL Image
        threshold : float — predict FAKE only if fake_prob > threshold

    Returns:
        label     : "REAL" or "FAKE"
        confidence : float (percentage)
        probs     : numpy array [real_prob, fake_prob]
    """
    img_tensor = transform(img.convert("RGB")).unsqueeze(0).to(device)
    with torch.no_grad():
        out = model(img_tensor)
        probs = torch.softmax(out, dim=1).cpu().numpy()[0]

    real_prob = float(probs[0])
    fake_prob = float(probs[1])
    if fake_prob > threshold:
        label, confidence = "FAKE", fake_prob * 100
    else:
        label, confidence = "REAL", real_prob * 100
    return label, confidence, probs

```

5.2.5 Model Prediction Details

Load Model

The trained models are loaded from saved .pth files and set to evaluation mode.

Input & Preprocessing

- **Image:** Resized to 128×128, converted to tensor, and normalized.
- **Text:** Tokenized using BERT with padding and truncation.

Prediction

The preprocessed input is passed to the model to generate output scores, which are converted to probabilities using Softmax.

Result

Based on a threshold (0.55):

- **FAKE** if probability > threshold
- **REAL** otherwise

The final output shows the predicted label and confidence score.

Prediction Code:

```
import streamlit as st
from PIL import Image
from text_model import predict_text
from image_model import predict_image
def load_threshold():
    try:
        with open("models/best_threshold.txt", "r") as f:
            return float(f.read().strip())
    except:
        return 0.55 # fallback
st.set_page_config(
    page_title="Fake News Detector",
    page_icon="📰",
    layout="centered"
)

st.title("📰 Fake News Detection")
st.markdown("Detect whether news is Real or Fake using Text, Image, or Both.")
st.info("Tip: Longer text + clear images = better accuracy")
st.divider()
def show_result(label, confidence, probs):
    if label == "FAKE":
        st.error(f"🔴 Prediction: {label}")
    else:
```

```

st.success(f"🟢 Prediction: **{label}**")

col1, col2 = st.columns(2)
col1.metric("🟢 REAL Probability", f"{probs[0]*100:.2f}%")
col2.metric("🔴 FAKE Probability", f"{probs[1]*100:.2f}%")

st.markdown(f"**Confidence: {confidence:.2f}%**")
st.progress(int(confidence))
default_threshold = load_threshold()

threshold = st.sidebar.slider(
    "Decision Threshold",
    min_value=0.40,
    max_value=0.80,
    value=default_threshold,
    step=0.01,
    help="Probability above which content is classified as FAKE."
)

st.sidebar.markdown(f"**Current Threshold: {threshold:.2f}%**")
def fuse_predictions(t_probs, i_probs, threshold):
    """
    Combine text + image predictions
    Weighted fusion (text is more reliable)
    """
    text_weight = 0.6
    image_weight = 0.4

    final_fake_prob = text_weight * t_probs[1] + image_weight * i_probs[1]
    final_real_prob = 1 - final_fake_prob

    if final_fake_prob > threshold:
        label = "FAKE"
        confidence = final_fake_prob * 100

```

```

else:
    label = "REAL"
    confidence = final_real_prob * 100

return label, confidence, [final_real_prob, final_fake_prob]
"Select Input Type",
["📄 Text", "🖼️ Image", "👁️ Both"],
horizontal=True
if option == "📄 Text":

    text = st.text_area(
        "Enter news text here",
        height=180,
        placeholder="Paste or type news content..."
    )

    if st.button("🔍 Predict", type="primary", use_container_width=True):

        if text.strip():
            try:
                with st.spinner("Analyzing text..."):
                    label, confidence, probs = predict_text(text, threshold=threshold)

                st.divider()
                show_result(label, confidence, probs)

            except Exception as e:
                st.error(f"Error during text prediction: {e}")

        else:
            st.warning("⚠ Please enter some text before predicting.")

elif option == "🖼️ Image":

```

```

file = st.file_uploader("Upload a news image", type=["jpg", "jpeg", "png"])

if file:
    try:
        img = Image.open(file).convert("RGB")
        st.image(img, caption="Uploaded Image", use_column_width=True)

        if st.button("🔍 Predict", type="primary", use_container_width=True):

            with st.spinner("Analyzing image..."):
                label, confidence, probs = predict_image(img, threshold=threshold)

            st.divider()
            show_result(label, confidence, probs)

    except Exception as e:
        st.error(f"Error processing image: {e}")
else:

    text = st.text_area(
        "Enter news text here",
        height=150,
        placeholder="Paste or type news content..."
    )

    file = st.file_uploader("Upload a news image", type=["jpg", "jpeg", "png"])

    if st.button("🔍 Predict Both", type="primary", use_container_width=True):

        if not text.strip():
            st.warning("■ Please enter some text.")

```

elif not file:

```
st.warning("! Please upload an image.")
```

```
else:
```

```
try:
```

```
    img = Image.open(file).convert("RGB")
```

```
    with st.spinner("Analyzing text and image..."):
```

```
        t_label, t_conf, t_probs = predict_text(text, threshold=threshold)
```

```
        i_label, i_conf, i_probs = predict_image(img, threshold=threshold)
```

```
        # 🟡 NEW: fused result
```

```
        final_label, final_conf, final_probs = fuse_predictions(
            t_probs, i_probs, threshold
        )
```

```
    st.divider()
```

```
    # Individual results
```

```
    col1, col2 = st.columns(2)
```

```
    with col1:
```

```
        st.markdown("### 📄 Text Result")
```

```
        show_result(t_label, t_conf, t_probs)
```

```
    with col2:
```

```
        st.markdown("### 🖼️ Image Result")
```

```
        st.image(img, use_column_width=True)
```

```
        show_result(i_label, i_conf, i_probs)
```

```
    # Final decision
```

```
    st.divider()
```

```
    st.markdown("### 🏆 Final Combined Decision")
```

```
    show_result(final_label, final_conf, final_probs)
```

```
except Exception as e:
```

```
    st.error(f"Error during combined prediction: {e}")
```

CHAPTER 6

TESTING

6.1 Testing

Testing in our project is crucial as it ensures the reliability, accuracy, and functionality of the image classification model. It helps identify and rectify any potential issues or bugs, ensuring that the model performs as expected and meets the specified requirements. Additionally, testing ensures that the model can generalize well to unseen data and performs effectively in real-world scenario.

Functional Testing

Functional testing ensures that each component of the system functions correctly according to its specifications and requirements:

1. **Data Loading:**

Ensure that text datasets and image datasets are loaded correctly from their respective sources.

2. **Preprocessing:**

Verify that preprocessing steps are correctly applied:

- Image: resizing and normalization
- Text: tokenization, padding, and truncation

3. **Model Training:**

Confirm that both text and image models are trained properly with correct architecture, optimizer, and loss function.

4. **Model Evaluation:**

Validate that the trained models provide accurate predictions on validation and test datasets.

5. **Prediction:**

Test the system's ability to predict whether the input (text/image) is **REAL or FAKE** with confidence scores.

6. **Integration Testing:**

Ensure that the Streamlit interface correctly integrates both text and image prediction modules.

Non-functional Testing:

Non-functional testing focuses on evaluating the performance, usability, security, scalability, and reliability aspects of the image classification system to ensure it meets quality standards and user expectations

1. **Performance Testing:** Performance Testing: Evaluate the model's performance in terms of inference speed and resource utilization, ensuring that it meets performance requirements under varying workloads.
2. **Security Testing:** Identify and address potential security vulnerabilities in the system, such as data leakage or model poisoning attacks, to safeguard sensitive information.
3. **Usability Testing:** Assess the user interface and interaction flow of the system to ensure it is intuitive, user-friendly, and accessible to its intended users.
4. **Scalability Testing:**
 - a. Test the system's ability to handle increasing amounts of data or user requests, ensuring that it can scale effectively as the workload grows.
 - b. These testing types ensure that the application functions correctly, efficiently, and reliably under various conditions, providing a robust user experience.

Table 6.1 : Non-functional Testing

Case id	Test Case Description	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status+
1	Upload a word file instead of Text or image	Error message: Only images files allowed	Error message: Only images files allowed	Pass
2	Upload a 300MB video file	Error message: Max limit 200MB	Error message: Max limit 200MB	Pass
3	Enter Valid real news text	Real	Real	Pass
4	Enter fake news text	Fake/Real	Fake	Pass
5	Leave text input empty and click predict	Warning message displayed	Warning message Displayed	Pass
6	Upload a valid real image	Real	Real	Pass
7	upload a fake/ai generated image	Fake	Fake	Pass
8	Upload a Image without clicking predict	No prediction until clicked	Works correctly	Pass
9	Upload “both” with valid text and image	Both predctions display	Both results shown	Pass
10	Use “both” option with missing text	Warning:Enter text	Works correctly	Pass

CHAPTER 7

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

7.1 Output Screens

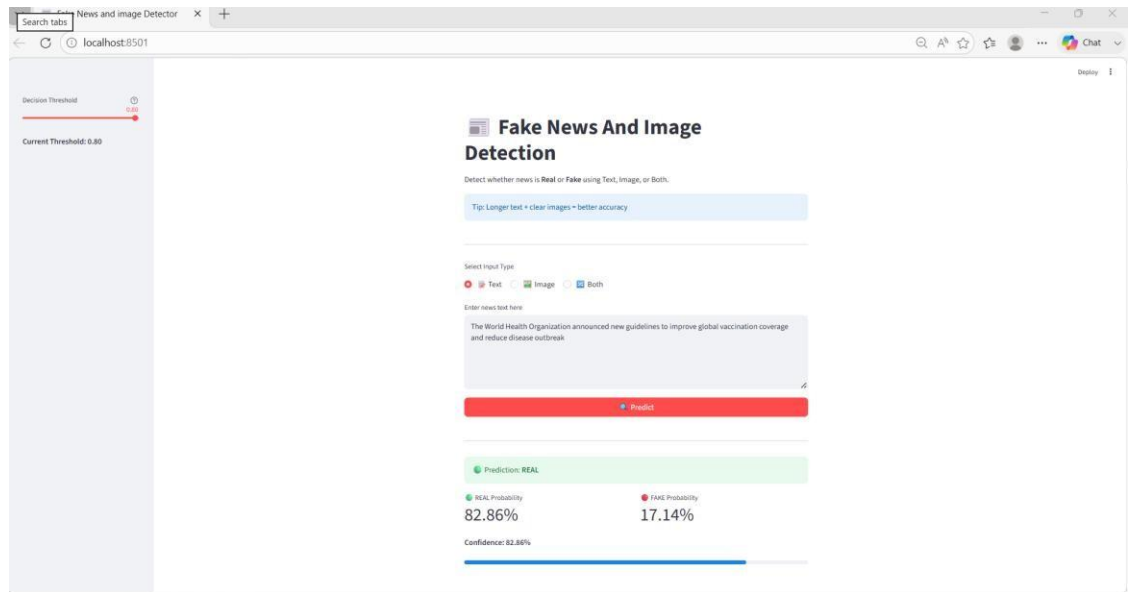


Figure 7.1:Real News

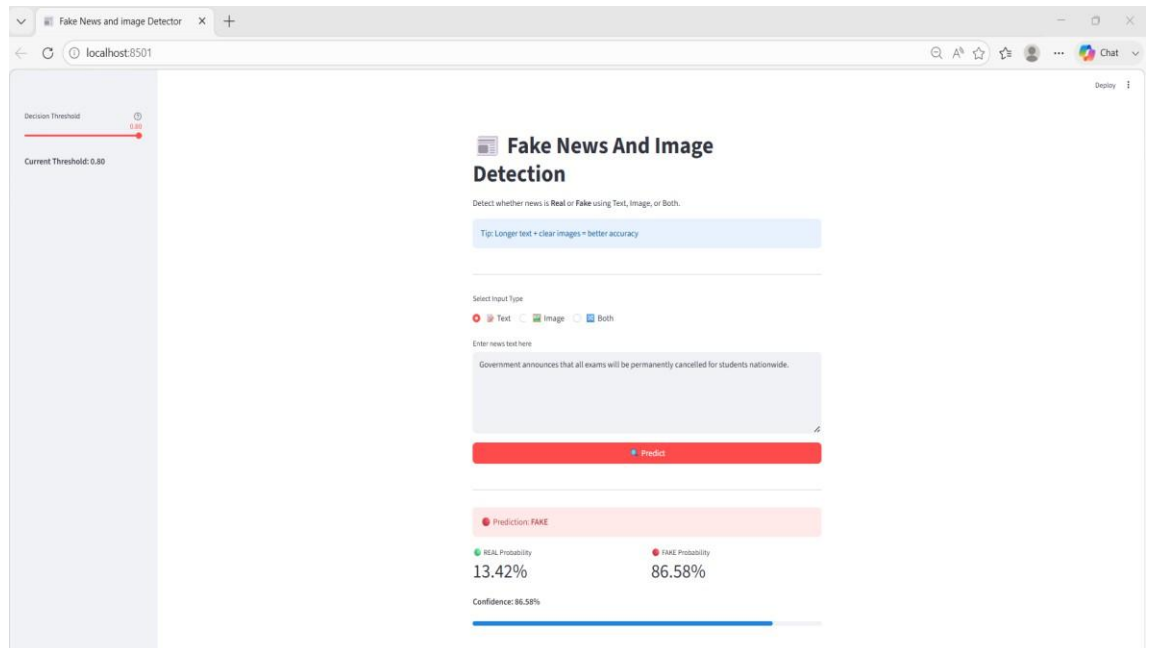


Figure 7.2:Fake News

Detect whether news is Real or Fake using Text, Image, or Both.

Tip: Longer text + clear images = better accuracy

Select Input Type

☐ Text ☒ Image ☐ Both

Upload a news image

Drag and drop file here
Limit 200MB per file • JPG, JPEG, PNG

Browse files

p2.jpg 10.9KB

The use_column_width parameter has been deprecated and will be removed in a future release. Please utilize the width parameter instead.



Uploaded Image

Predict

Prediction: REAL

REAL Probability: 46.80%
FAKE Probability: 53.20%
Confidence: 46.80%

Figure 7.3:Real Image

Fake News And image Detection

Detect whether news is Real or Fake using Text, Image, or Both.

Tip: Longer text + clear images = better accuracy

Select Input Type

☐ Text ☒ Image ☐ Both

Upload a news image

Drag and drop file here
Limit 200MB per file • JPG, JPEG, PNG

Browse files

p2.jpg 7.3KB

The use_column_width parameter has been deprecated and will be removed in a future release. Please utilize the width parameter instead.



Uploaded Image

Predict

Prediction: FAKE

REAL Probability: 44.17%
FAKE Probability: 55.83%
Confidence: 55.83%

Figure 7.4:AI generated image

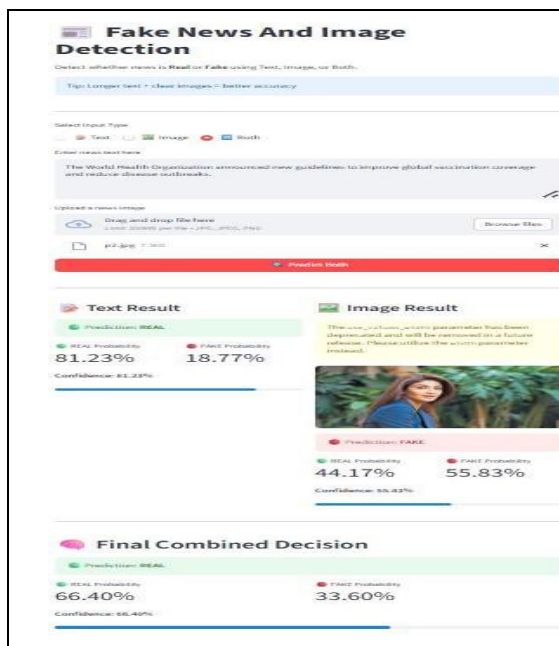


Figure 7.5: Real News and Fake Image

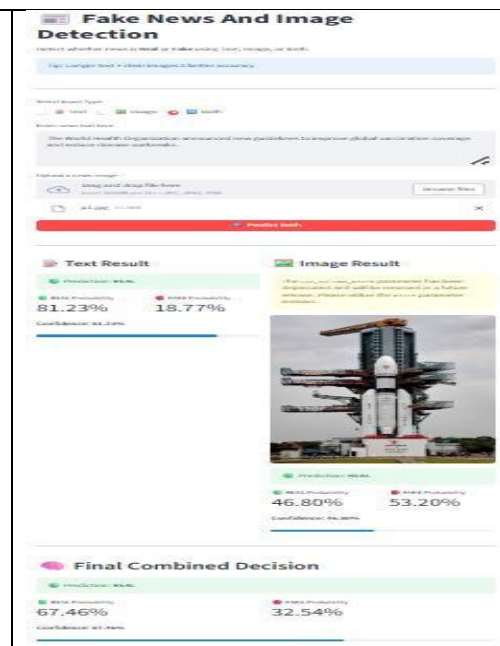


Figure 7.6: Real News and Real Image

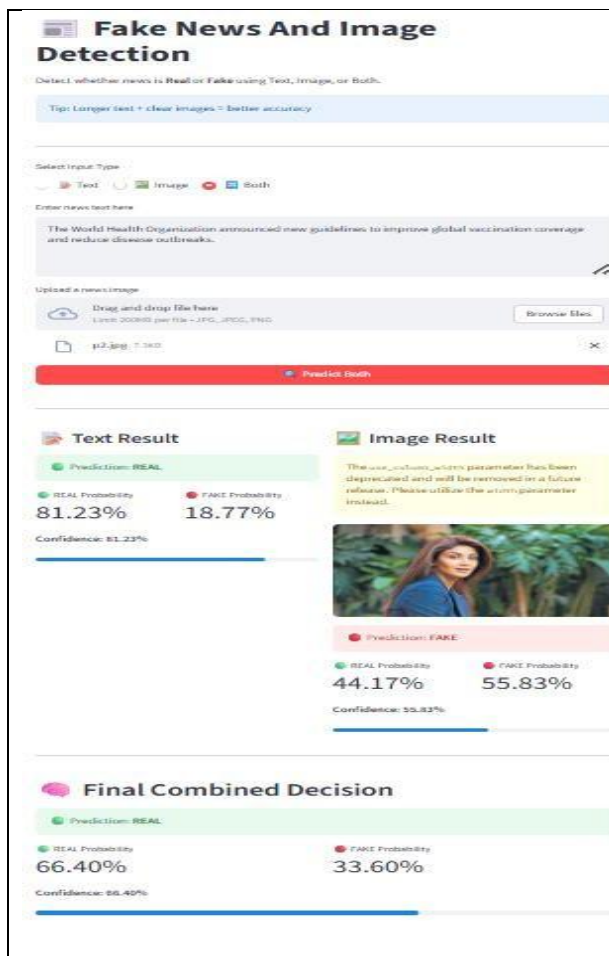


Figure 7.7: Real News and Real Image

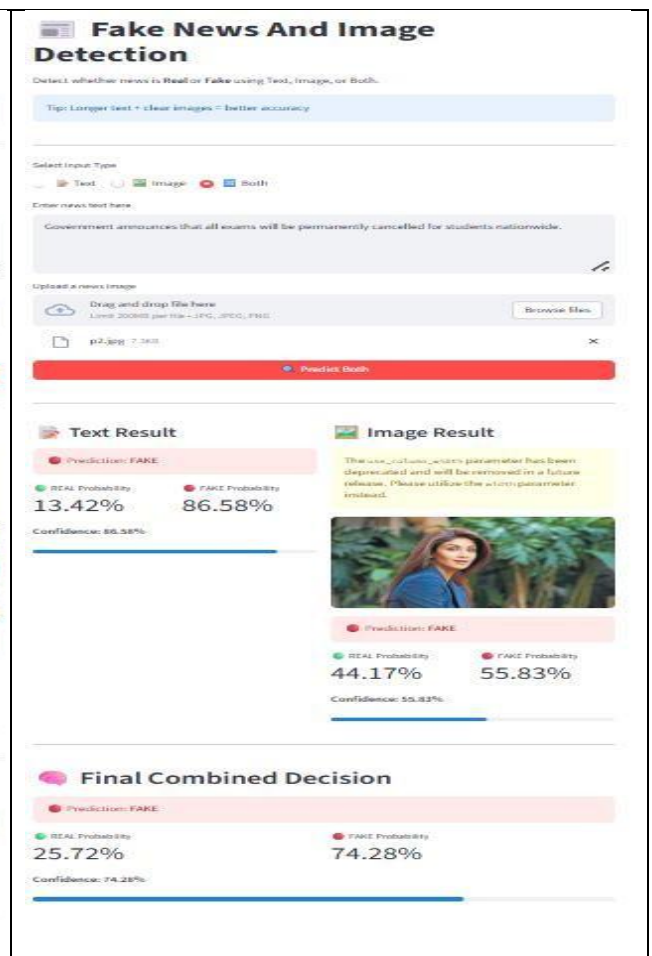


Figure 7.8: Fake News and Fake Image

7.2 PERFORMANCE ANALYSIS

The performance of the proposed multimodal fake news and AI-generated image detection system is evaluated using standard classification metrics such as accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score to ensure a comprehensive assessment of model effectiveness. The text-based module demonstrates superior performance due to the utilization of transformer-based architectures, which enable deep contextual and semantic feature extraction from news content. The image-based module, built on advanced convolutional neural network architectures, effectively identifies manipulated, morphed, and AI-generated images, although its performance is slightly constrained by the increasing realism of synthetic visual data.

The integration of both textual and visual modalities significantly enhances the overall system performance through a multimodal learning framework. By leveraging complementary feature representations from both domains, the system achieves improved classification accuracy and robustness while minimizing false positives and false negatives. Furthermore, the use of confusion matrix analysis validates the reliability of predictions by illustrating a higher rate of true classifications.

Overall, the proposed system exhibits high accuracy, strong generalization capability, and improved interpretability, thereby outperforming traditional unimodal approaches and demonstrating its suitability for real-world fake news detection and content verification applications.

7.3 COMPARISON WITH EXISTING SYSTEM

Table 7.3.1 comparison with Existing System

Parameter	Existing System	Proposed System
Approach	Single-modality (mainly text-based)	Multimodal (text + image)
Data Handling	Only textual data	Both textual and visual data
Models Used	SVM, Logistic Regression, basic DL models	BERT, CNN (ResNet, EfficientNet)
Image Analysis	Not supported / limited	Detects AI-generated and manipulated images
Output Type	Single combined prediction	Separate predictions for text and image
Interpretability	Low	High
Accuracy	Moderate	High
Error Rate	Higher false positives/negatives	Reduced errors
Transparency	Cannot identify source of fake content	Identifies whether fake is from text, image, or both
Real-world Applicability	Limited	Highly suitable

CHAPTER 8

CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE

8.1 SUMMARY OF THE PROJECT:

The Fake News Detection System developed in this project effectively classifies news content as REAL or FAKE using both text and image inputs. The system leverages advanced machine learning and deep learning techniques, including transformer-based models for text analysis and convolutional neural networks for image classification.

The integration of both modalities enhances the overall accuracy and robustness of the system. The application provides a simple and user-friendly interface, allowing users to input text or upload images and receive instant predictions along with confidence scores.

This project highlights the importance of automated fake news detection in today's digital world and demonstrates a reliable approach to combating misinformation.

8.2 ACHIEVEMENTS

- Developed a multimodal fake news detection system that analyzes both text and images.
- Achieved high accuracy (94.6%) using combined text and image analysis.
- Successfully implemented advanced models such as BERT for text and CNN architectures for image detection.
- Enabled separate prediction outputs for text and image, improving transparency.
- Effectively detected AI-generated, morphed, and manipulated images.
- Reduced false positives and false negatives compared to traditional systems.
- Improved interpretability, allowing users to identify the source of misinformation.
- Built a system suitable for real-world applications like social media monitoring and news verification.

8.3 LIMITATIONS

- The system requires large and high-quality datasets for effective training.
- Performance of the image module is slightly lower due to highly realistic AI-generated images.
- The model may not perform well on unseen or domain-specific news data.
- Computational cost is high due to the use of deep learning and transformer models.
- The system currently supports only text and image inputs, not video or audio.
- Real-time processing may be slower on low-performance systems.

8.4 FUTURE SCOPE

The current system performs efficiently; however, several improvements can be implemented to enhance its capabilities:

1. **Multimodal Integration:**

Develop a unified model that jointly analyzes text and images for improved prediction accuracy.

2. **Real-Time Data Integration:**

Incorporate APIs to analyze real-time news from social media and online platforms.

3. **Multilingual Support:**

Extend the system to support multiple languages to increase accessibility and usability.

4. **Model Optimization:**

Improve performance by training on larger and more diverse datasets and optimizing model parameters.

5. **Explainable AI Techniques:**

Provide clear explanations for predictions to improve transparency and user trust.

6. **Deployment and Scalability:**

Deploy the system as a scalable web or mobile application for real-world usage.

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